

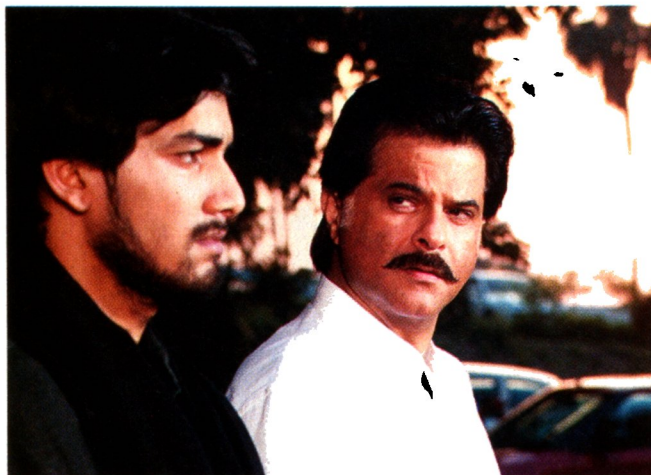
film review

Imperfect Shade

BLACK AND WHITE

Director: Subhash Ghai
Starring: Anurag Sinha, Anil Kapoor, Habib Tanvir

Subhash Ghai has always had a very strong notion of politics. At his pulpiest best, films such as *Khalnayak* and *Karma* have made strong statements not only about the limits of the state but also about what is the correct moral order. Invariably hidden beneath the *Choli ke peecheys* and the *My name is Lakhans*, there has been a powerful social intent—although it has to be said sometimes it is lost in the clamour of his glamour. In *Black and White*, Ghai has attacked the subject of morality in a less oblique fashion. What kind of society is it that drives a man to commit a horrendous crime? But then he has gone and di-



GREY AREA: Sinha and Kapoor in *Black and White*

luted everything by not only turning this terrorist into an outsider planted by the Taliban (and not a product of indigenous communal hatred) but also making the film quite badly. As an idea the microcosmic communal harmony of Delhi's Chandni Chowk is marvellous, provided the viewer did not have to contend with Shefali Shah's hamming, Anil Kapoor's cardboard cutout of a Hindu professor teaching Urdu and peaceful co-existence, and Sinha's

unshaven sullenness. This is a one-note movie that deserves a one-star response. For more stirring comments on the desperation bred in entire ethnicities by the neglect and sometimes plain cruelty of the majority, please refer to movies ranging from M.S. Sathyu's *Garam Hawa* to Saeed Akhtar Mirza's *Naseem*. Mr Show-man, time to show some old style flash. Social comment is a dish best served masala hot. **by Kaveree Bamzai**

recommendations

Brick Bats

DELHI Migrants might be causing uproar in some parts of the country but photo-journalist Harish Tyagi sees their lives in an entirely different light through his lense.

In an exhibition titled *Distress Migration and its Effect on Children*, Tyagi's pictures tell an often-sordid, sometimes-enchanted tale of villagers who work in the brick kilns of northern states like Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Punjab and Rajasthan. While half of these workers are women, there are many children working in the kilns who the pictures



LOADED: A photo by Tyagi show braving childhood with cartloads of bricks in their tender hands, amusing themselves flying kites next to smoke billowing chimneys or watching battery-run television sets perched atop their brick carts at night.

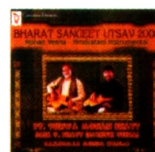
Also on display are photographs by P. Madhavan, a freelance photographer who is working on the impact of radiation on children in the uranium mines of Jharkhand. At Habitat Centre till March 17.

by Shalini S. Sharma

music reviews

Fusion of Sound

Jugalbandis in concerts are more tamasha and less pure music. That is because the chemistry between two artistes rarely integrates. At times the artistes meet just an hour before the concert and decide on the ragas to be performed on the stage. And the result is chaos, with each artiste trying to out do the other. But *Bharat Sangeet Utsav* and *Walking Together* are two albums which are a departure from this trend. Here you can witness a perfect harmony between two stalwarts.



Carnatica
Rs 150

BHARAT SANGEET UTSAV

The credit for adapting the western Spanish

guitar to the mohan veena goes to Pandit Vishwa Mohan Bhatt. In the album *Bharat Sangeet Utsav*, he along with his son Salil V. Bhatt, performs two ragas—puriya dhanashri and hamsadhwani. His master strokes overshadow the son's swift ones. Rich in melody, it is literally music to the ears.



Navras

WALKING TOGETHER

Sitar player Gaurav Mazumdar and veena

player Jayanthi Kumaresh in their album *Walking Together* perform ragas kalavati, yaman and the famous bhajan *Vaishnava jana*. While Mazumdar belongs to the Hindustani tradition, Kumaresh follows the Carnatic tradition. But in their recital the two traditions fuse to produce scintillating music.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit